

— A PARTNERSHIP PLATFORM FROM THE DAVID ECCLES SCHOOL OF BUSINESS

# PLAYERS ACADEMY.

PROFESSIONAL LEARNING AND  
YEAR-ROUND EXPERIENTIAL READINESS

A structured, experiential program connecting **DESB students with Utah's**  
**growing sports industry.**

DAVID ECCLES SCHOOL OF BUSINESS  
UNIVERSITY OF UTAH  
BUSINESS OF SPORTS · FALL 2027

# BUSINESS OF SPORTS.

**361** : **17** : **01** : **39**  
DAYS   HRS   MIN   SEC

— UNTIL FIRST CLASS  
MON · 23 AUG 2027 · 7:30 AM MT

**21**  
**CREDIT HOURS**

9 core · 3 experiential · 9 elective

THE PROGRAM

- University of Utah · David Eccles School of Business
- Department of Entrepreneurship & Strategy
- A minor — open to **every U of U undergraduate**
- Vision: **Stadium to Summit** · Mission: Sports Leadership

**31**  
**CHAMPIONSHIP TEAMS**

A university of athletic champions

FOCUS & EDGE

- **Academic Focus:** Analytics · Brands · Experience
- AI-fluent — without skipping the business fundamentals
- Fan engagement, taught as a discipline
- Sales strategy integrated into every course



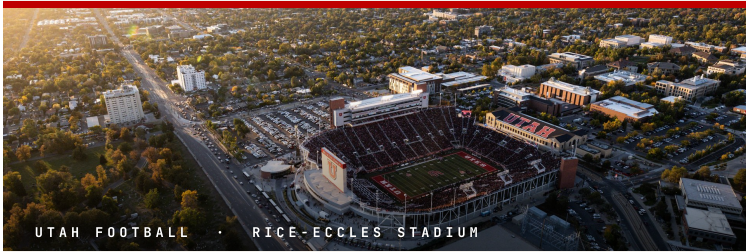


FOCUS 01

# ANALYTICS

TRANSFORMING NUMBERS **INTO STRATEGY.**

- Sponsorship ROI
- Media rights valuation
- Athlete analytics
- Data-driven decisions



FOCUS 02

# BRANDS

WHERE SPORT **MEETS CULTURE.**

- Brand & product development
- Storytelling & activation
- Athlete brand management
- Culture intersection



FOCUS 03

# EXPERIENCES

FROM CONCEPT **TO LEGACY.**

- Venue design
- Corporate partner integration
- Universal access & experience innovation
- Community impact & legacy
- Event management & operations

WOVEN THROUGH  
EVERY COURSE

**01** ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

**02** FAN ENGAGEMENT

**03** SALES STRATEGY

OUR UNIQUE ADVANTAGE

# UTAH SPORTS INDUSTRY.

Anchored by **Utah Athletics & Crimson Brand Partners**,  
spanning major & emerging leagues, recreation, brands,  
wellness, the Olympic movement & NGBs, and events —  
Utah's full sports stack.

THE ANCHOR

COLLEGE ATHLETICS



ACTIVE PARTNERS

MAJOR LEAGUE



ACTIVE PARTNERS

EMERGING LEAGUE



ACTIVE PARTNERS

RESORTS



ACTIVE PARTNERS

BRANDS



ACTIVE PARTNERS

WELLNESS



ACTIVE PARTNERS

OLYMPIC, PARALYMPIC & NGB



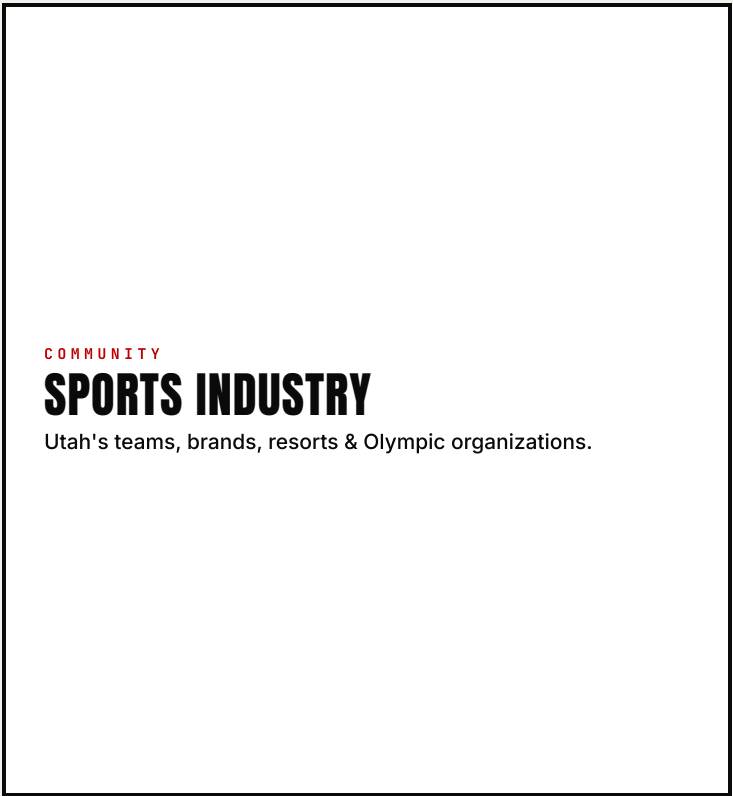
ACTIVE PARTNERS

EVENTS



# CONNECTING CAMPUS TO COMMUNITY.

The minor builds the foundation. The PLAYERS Academy turns the required **3-credit experiential class** into real placements with Utah's sports industry.



CORE

Intro to Sports Business · Intro to Marketing · Principles of Management

9 CR

EXPERIENTIAL

Sports Business Internship / Capstone — delivered by the PLAYERS Academy.

3 CR

ELECTIVES

Sports Marketing · Analytics · Media · Law & Sports · Event Mgmt · Sports Mgmt · Winter Olympics

9 CR



— THE EXPERIENTIAL ENGINE

# THE PLAYERS ACADEMY.

PROFESSIONAL LEARNING AND  
YEAR-ROUND EXPERIENTIAL READINESS



— WHAT IS THE PLAYERS ACADEMY?

# PARTNERSHIP PLATFORM.

PROFESSIONAL LEARNING AND  
YEAR-ROUND EXPERIENTIAL READINESS

The Business of Sports' dedicated experiential engine. A structured, accountable, credit-bearing program that places students inside Utah's sports industry with vetted employer partners.

---

FOR STUDENTS

**Curated placements, academic credit, and a clear path** from classroom to career in the sports industry.

---

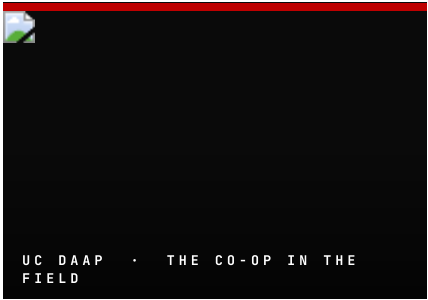
FOR EMPLOYERS

**Access to trained, motivated DESB talent** with structured onboarding expectations and defined responsibilities.

---

FOR THE PROGRAM

**Real-world outcomes** that strengthen the minor's credibility, donor appeal, and industry reputation.



SOURCE

**UNIVERSITY OF CINCINNATI**  
**DAAP CO-OP, EST. 1906.**

Cincinnati's Design Art, Architecture and Planning co-op program is **nationally ranked** and renowned for turning classroom learning into career readiness. The PLAYERS Academy borrows its best DNA.

**2,000+**

METRIC 01

**EMPLOYER PARTNERS**

The size of DAAP's active partner network — the bench Utah's industry advisors are quietly already building.

**37**

METRIC 02

**U.S. STATES**

The geographic reach of DAAP placements — proof that a co-op program built in one city can scale national.

**22**

METRIC 03

**COUNTRIES**

Global placement footprint — a useful benchmark as Utah hosts the 2034 Winter Games and the world arrives.

**#1**

METRIC 04

**NATIONALLY RANKED**

The model isn't theoretical. It's the #1 co-op program in the U.S. — proven for over a century.

**WHAT WE BORROW.**

- Proven university infrastructure
- End-of-term showcase deliverable
- Pre-placement readiness
- Vetted employer network
- Mutual accountability contracts
- Focus-based placements (not random)
- Credit integrated into curriculum
- Two-sided commitment, in writing



# EIGHT PILLARS. HOW IT'S BUILT.

The eight structural commitments that hold the PLAYERS Academy together. Each one is non-negotiable.

**01**

## **READINESS COURSEWORK**

Pre-placement coursework: industry landscape, networking, salary negotiation, front office culture.

**02**

## **CREDIT BEARING. BY DESIGN.**

Every internship placement earns credit toward your degree. Non-negotiable. A signal that this work counts.

**03**

## **MUTUAL ACCOUNTABILITY**

Two-sided contract: employers commit to structure; students commit to attendance & deliverables.

**04**

## **DEDICATED ACADEMY**

In collaboration with University Career Success, a platform that ensures proper matchmaking, placement quality, and continuous data collection.

**05**

## **THE ROSTER NETWORK**

Curated sports industry partners across Utah & USA — teams, resorts, brands, NGBs.

**06**

## **FLEXIBLE OPTIONS**

Internships (full-semester), Projects (group or individual), Events (volunteer opportunities).

**07**

## **CAPSTONE SHOWCASE**

Students present a case study, campaign, or analysis at a public end-of-term event.

**08**

## **THREE PATHWAYS**

Track-based placements aligned to the minor's focus: Analytics, Brands & Experiences.

PILLAR 01

— BEFORE YOU PLAY

# THE READINESS COURSE.

Before any placement, every PLAYERS Academy student completes **Sports Business Readiness Coursework** — the foundation for professional success in the sports industry. Delivered via training videos and tracked in the Academy platform.

## THE OUTCOME

**Students arrive prepared** — not learning the basics on the employer's time. Employers notice the difference. That's the quality signal that brings them back.

FROM CORE CLASSES TO PLACEMENT • THE GATE WE WON'T MOVE



DAVID ECCLES SCHOOL OF BUSINESS • GARFF BUILDING

COURSE MODULES • FIVE GATES



## FIVE MODULES. EVERY PLAYER COMPLETES THEM.

- 01** SPORTS INDUSTRY LANDSCAPE & CAREER MAPPING
- 02** RESUME, COVER LETTER & MOCK INTERVIEWS
- 03** FRONT OFFICE & AGENCY CULTURE
- 04** NETWORKING & PROFESSIONAL ETHICS
- 05** EXPECTATIONS & ACCOUNTABILITY

READINESS COURSEWORK • THE PRE-PLACEMENT REQUIREMENT



# THE TWO-SIDED CONTRACT.

Every party has a vested interest. Two columns, equal weight. This is what the PLAYERS Academy puts in writing — what students sign, and what employers sign.

## STUDENT COMMITS TO

### THE PLAYER.

- Complete core classes before placement
- Show up — attendance is non-negotiable
- Submit weekly check-ins to the Academy
- Complete assigned deliverables on schedule
- Attend the mid-semester review meeting
- Present capstone at end-of-term Showcase
- Maintain professional conduct at all times

## EMPLOYER COMMITS TO

### THE PARTNER.

- Pay interns a defined hourly wage
- Provide a named supervisor of record
- Define role responsibilities in writing
- Hold a structured onboarding session
- Complete the mid-semester evaluation form
- Attend the end-of-term Showcase event
- Submit a post-placement feedback survey

# WHY WE'RE BUILDING IT.

*The hardest part about breaking into the sports industry is landing that first opportunity. I wish I'd had access to a program like this — it's going to be incredibly popular.*

**SULLIVAN EVANS**

ASPIRING SPORTS & ENTERTAINMENT PROFESSIONAL • CLASS OF 2026 • DESB ALUMNI

*I have lots of experience struggling to find internships and professional opportunities as a college student, so I am in full support of a program-specific office dedicated to student networking.*

*I'm excited for future students to have a great network like the PLAYERS Academy — and it has been an amazing opportunity to help shape this program from the student perspective.*

**AUDREY ARTZ**

QAMO MAJOR • CLASS OF 2028 • FOUNDING STUDENT VOICE

*After hearing about the PLAYERS Academy, I thought it helped to bridge a gap that students are constantly looking to fill. Getting your foot in the door within the sports industry can be difficult, so I think this program will give students entering the program the experience they need to enter the industry.*

*I especially loved how internships are required for students to participate in, and that the school will help them find one within sports. I think this will help students stand out amongst applicants from other schools due to the early experience they'll have.*

**WINTER CHAMBERLAIN**

MARKETING MAJOR • BUSINESS ANALYTICS MINOR • CLASS OF 2027

# THINGS TO SOLVE.

## 01 STUDENT COMPENSATION & CREDIT

The model calls for paid internships, with the financial transaction kept between student and employer (not routed through the program). Students earn course credit. Is that workable within university policy — and how do we reconcile the "paid" commitment with project-based engagements that may not carry compensation?

## 02 PROJECTS VS. INTERNSHIPS

How should structured projects (e.g. Utah Baseball analytics) be classified and managed within the Academy? Do they follow the same accountability framework as internships, and how do credit, compensation, and employer expectations differ?

## 03 OPERATIONAL ROLES & RESPONSIBILITIES

What does Career Services' day-to-day involvement look like? What's the realistic staffing and workflow required to run placements, manage employer relationships, and track outcomes — especially given a Fall 2027 launch? When should a leader be activated?

## 04 COORDINATION WITH CAREER SUCCESS

All positions should likely be posted through U Career Success for institutional alignment. But the Academy's value proposition to employers is a *curated* candidate pipeline — not a public job board. How do we preserve that curation while working within the university's existing career infrastructure?



# ASCENT BEGINS *HERE.*

DAVID ECCLES SCHOOL OF BUSINESS · UNIVERSITY OF UTAH  
BUSINESS OF SPORTS · PLAYERS ACADEMY · FALL 2027